

PLAYER REPORT



SOUMAILA FANÉ

— POSITION:

LEFT WINGER

PREPARED BY: | MARYANN MUKIEBE
mukiebemaryann22@gmail.com



Games Watched:

- Morocco U-17 vs Mali U-17 (AFCON Final Stage)
- **Minutes Watched:** 90 Minutes

Date: 09.06.2026



PLAYER PROFILE

- **Full Name:** Soumaila Fané
- **Date of Birth:** 25 December 2009
- **Age:** 16 years old (as of 2026)
- **Nationality:** Malian
- **National Team:** Mali U-17 ML
- **Position:** Winger / Attacking Midfielder (mainly left side)

GAME STATS

- Total Games: 1
- Starting XI: 1
- Minutes: 90
- G/A: 0
- Discipline: 1YC

OVERALL SUMMARY

- Soumaila Fané is a young Malian winger/attacking midfielder who likes to drift from the left but is a linker from midfield to attack.
- The technique is solid and he is assured when on the ball.
- Very good in tight areas he likes playing combination passes.
- His dribbling is more a means of maintaining possession as opposed to an explosive dribble and he will more often feed in play as opposed to producing the final action.
- In a high intensity game as in Morocco U-17 vs Mali U-17, compact formations really limits the influence he can exert. A system player and a creator who needs to develop in the final third.



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TECHNICAL ATTRIBUTES

- **Ball Control:** Fané was solid when it came to his touch and control in non-pressurized situations and in building from the back with short passing sequences.
- **Passing:** He was extremely reliable when passing short distances, but he was not daring enough to make dangerous or creative passes in the final third.
- **Dribbling:** He showed some ability in carrying the ball forward for short periods but did not regularly beat opponents one-on-one.

MENTALITY ATTRIBUTES

- **Work Rate:** Fané was willing to chase down the ball, press opponents, and track back to support his teammates throughout the entire match.
- **Composure:** He was composed on the ball when building from the back, but at times played safe or hurried passes when under pressure or when attempting an attacking play.
- **Resilience** Fané did not lose determination even though he was not the most decisive attacking player on the field.

TACTICAL ATTRIBUTES

- **Positioning:** At times he dropped too deep and at other times he did not find himself in advanced spaces when he needed to be there.
- **Movement:** He had an awareness for available space and made movements into it but was not consistently targeted or effective with his movements.
- **Defensive Structure:** He worked diligently to provide defensive cover and maintain compactness as he diligently tracked back to help the team defensively.

PHYSICAL ATTRIBUTES

- **Explosiveness:** He demonstrated a rapid burst of acceleration when carrying the ball and when being pressed. He however did not consistently separate from his markers for long distances.
- **Stamina:** He worked diligently over the course of the entire match with no reduction in effort between defending and supporting his forwards.
- **Physicality in Duels:** He found it a bit challenging in the physical aspect of tight duels, especially when under immense structural defensive pressure.



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OFFENSIVE COMPETENCIES

DRIBBLING & BALL CARRYING

PLAYMAKING & COMBINATION PLAY

- **1v1 Success:** Failed to beat his man in individual 1v1 situations, where despite dribbling in, it seemed like he would often get blocked off by the tight marking he received from Morocco.
- **Ball Control at Speed:** Kept the ball close to his feet when driving at speed, but struggled to combine keeping possession at pace with bursting beyond defenders.
- **Direction Changes:** Attempted quick shifts of pace with some slight alterations of direction, however they did not make him more or less accessible to markers.
- **Carry Impact:** Advanced play into the middle third and intermediate positions through ball carrying, however struggled to move beyond the halfway line and make deep final third contributions.
- **Space Awareness:** Frequently arrived in available spaces to combine into builds but did not consistently move between lines into threatening areas.
- **Body Orientation:** At times, received the ball with a sound body shape in possession to turn or play forwards, but this was sporadic under pressure.
- **Quality of Pass Accurate:** His passing remained dependable in short sequences but was rarely penetrative in forward areas.
- **Tempo Control:** Kept hold of possession and provided stability, without adding significant pace to attacks.



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OFFENSIVE COMPETENCIES

RUNS IN BEHIND

- **Timing of Runs:** He made some well timed movements though often ignored by teammates.
- **Acceleration:** Made short sprints forward, although they did not give him separation in behind.
- **Direction of Runs:** He made diagonal runs into space but it was picked out by Morocco's organized defense relatively early on each occasion.
- **Recognition:** He recognized attacking space but was rarely played through in those moments.
- **Coordination Movement:** His movement was often disconnected from the midfield passing intention.

FINAL THIRD IMPACT

- **Crossing Quality:** Not often the one creating opportunities in wide areas.
- **Through Balls:** He did not frequently attempt line-breaking passes in the final third.
- **Decision Making:** Mostly decided on the secure option when it was there rather than a riskier or creative pass.
- **Execution Speed:** Played the ball fast when there were defensive pressures though was rarely inventive.
- **Creativity:** Not a significant creator of scoring chances.



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OFFENSIVE COMPETENCIES

GOAL THREAT & FINISHING

- **Positioning:** He had very little of these goal-scoring areas throughout the match.
- **Shot selection:** He got very little of the ball in a shooting situation throughout this match.
- **Finishing variety:** It was not evident what ability to finish from a variety of situations the striker possesses.
- **Composure:** He saw little opportunity for moments that require extreme cool-headed finishing in a high-stakes situation.
- **Output:** He produced no goals or notable shot output in this match.

BALL CARRYING

- **Dribbles through midfield space:** He was able to retain possession while running, but was rarely able to accelerate past players while carrying.
- **Breaks opponent lines with carries:** Morocco's defensive structure restricted his ability to carry through lines.
- **Control at speed:** He was rarely able to successfully dribble past opposition defenders in the center of the pitch.
- **Chance Creation:** His carries rarely contributed directly to the creation of attacks.



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DEFENSIVE COMPETENCIES

DYNAMIC PRESSING

- **Energetic:** Sato is willing to push and will be involved in the recovery of possession, particularly at transitional times.
- **Responsive:** His fast reaction to turnovers enables him to put a lot of pressure as soon as it happens, and this helps to break the rhythm of the opponent.
- **Disruptive:** He is able to make errors by forcing using pressing and intelligent movement and therefore he is effective during defensive high energy phases.

DEFENSIVE DUELING

- **Reactive:** Sato responds swiftly when he loses control of the ball, and in many cases, he tries to get back the ball or rectify errors in positioning.
- **Limited:** He has physical impairments that impair his performance in duels, especially air and shoulder-to-shoulder duels.
- **Developing:** The ability to develop technique and timing is not yet consistently developed, which is why the defensive fundamentals have to be enhanced.



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DEFENSIVE COMPETENCIES

HIGH PRESSING

- **Press timing:** Good awareness of when to engage a Morocco attacker and trigger pressure. Could sometimes be slow to initiate an press as Morocco built up play and could press earlier.
- **Approach speed:** He closed down the opponents aggressively when attempting a press.
- **Body shape:** Directed opposition to safer zones. The angle of his body often forced the opponent onto the wing and into a wider, less dangerous area.

TRACKING BACK & DEFENSIVE SUPPORT

- **Recovery runs:** Recovered well after possession lost. He frequently made recovery runs back to support the team's shape after an attacking transition occurred.
- **Defensive 1v1:** Good support work on the outside when 1v1 with the attacker or tracking overlapping runs.
- **Awareness:** Maintained good awareness of overlapping runs into wider areas and tracked them well.



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STRENGTHS

- Work rate and defensive effort throughout the whole game.
- Positive carrying the ball on open space and in transition.
- Decent short passing and simple interplay.
- Strong mentality, good confidence, and fight in clutch situations.
- Hard work while pressing and chasing back.

AREAS FOR IMPROVEMENT

- 1v1 effectiveness when the space is small and in attacking duels
- Quality and imagination in the final ball in the attacking third
- Decision-making in high-pressure situations (hold it vs release it)
- Movement off the ball and timing of runs in attacking situations
- Physical strength and competitiveness in hard duels.



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INVESTMENT

- Soumaila Fané is a long-term developmental investment as opposed to an immediate impact attacker.
- His strengths and appeal currently lie more in his work rate, ball progression and tactical discipline than final output.
- He remains rough around the edges in the final third, with his ceiling entirely reliant on a good coaching setup and structured development. If his decision making, physique and attacking output increase significantly over time, the ceiling is there to be reached..

STRATEGIC FIT

Fané is ideally suited for systems focused on structured buildup and linking the ball up on the flanks or in half-spaces, rather than pure isolation winger systems. He thrives in situations where:

- He can take the ball, link the play up, rather than be tasked with taking players on.
 - He is deployed as a supporting wide player or an inside-left link player.
 - The team operates with a pressing-orientated mentality and a sense of collective responsibility on the defensive side.
- He will not excel as the type of player asked to continually dominate 1v1s or consistently create a high volume of chances from the final third.

RECOMMENDATION

- Improve final third decision making – pass vs carry vs shoot
- Enhance 1v1 efficiency in close spaces via repetition and confidence building
- Bolster physique and dueling strength for higher level play
- Train his timing of attacking runs and final-third positioning
- Continue to utilize strengths in pressing, work rate, and carrying the ball, while adding the final product over time.